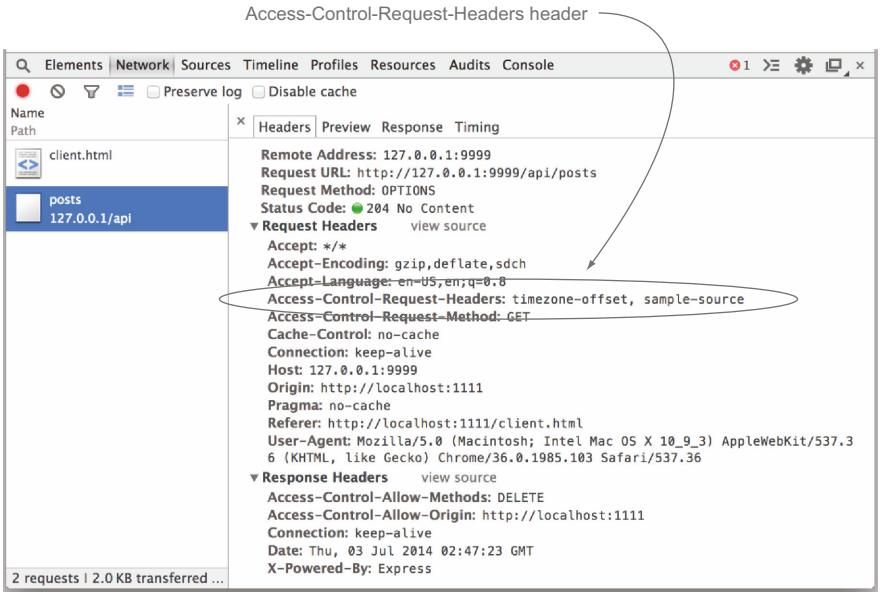


Figure 4.15 Preflight request has a new Access-Control-Request-Headers header

> **NOTE** It may be surprising to see that the preflight request is sent even though the request is a `GET` request. After all, didn't we add support for `GET` requests in chapter 3? Adding custom headers to a cross-origin request is a new functionality that wasn't possible before CORS. Therefore, it needs a preflight, even if the HTTP method wouldn't normally trigger a preflight.

In the same way that the Access-Control-Request-Method header asks permission to use a particular HTTP method, the Access-Control-Request-Headers header asks permission to send additional headers to the server. Table 4.3 shows how the request maps onto the Access-Control-Request-Headers header.

Table 4.3 Mapping the actual request headers to the preflight

Preflight request	Actual request

`OPTIONS /api/posts HTTP/1.1`
`User-Agent: Chrome`
`Host: 127.0.0.1:9999`
`Accept: */*`
`Origin: http://localhost:1111`
`Access-Control-Request-Method: GET`
`Access-Control-Request-Headers: Timezone-Offset, Sample-Source`
	`GET` `/api/posts HTTP/1.1`
	`User-Agent: Chrome`
	`Host: 127.0.0.1:9999`
	`Accept: */*`
	`Origin: http://localhost:1111`
	`Timezone-Offset: 300`
	`Sample-Source: Cors in Action`

The Access-Control-Request-Headers header serves a similar purpose as its Access-Control-Request-Method counterpart, but there are differences. While the Access-Control-Request-Method header can have only one value, the Access-Control-Request-Headers header